VELO CAFE

espresso · bike-repair · Brussels · Saint-Gilles · 18 m² · eight weeks

DEFINITION

Your bike.
Your espresso.
One Saint-Gilles corner.

A Brussels espresso bar with a full-service bike mechanic in the middle of the room — drop off the bike, nurse a cortado, ride home by the time you finish the saucer.

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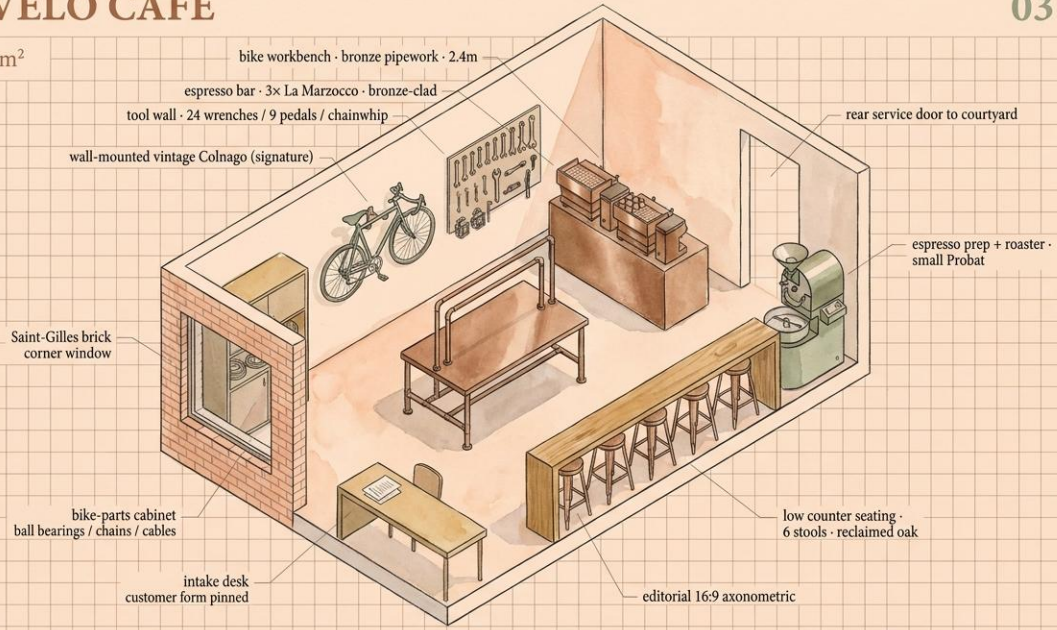
PLAN · 18 m²



THE CORNER

BONJOUR

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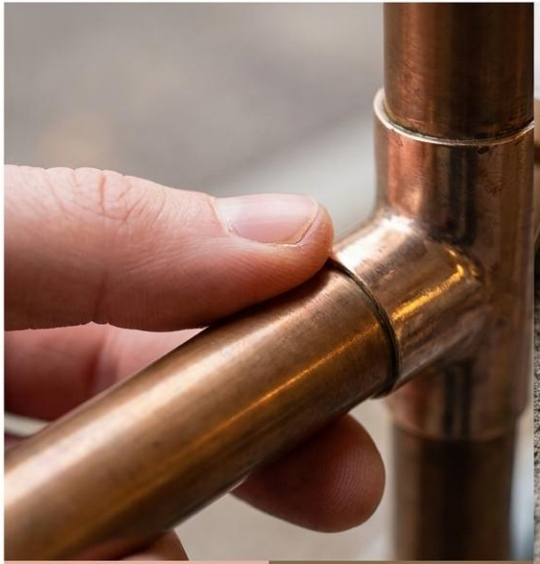
THE ROOM



THE SADDLE POUR

FOUR THINGS

Bronze-clad Portafilter & Tamp

Colnago Bottom Bracket & Chainring

Leather Brooks Saddle

Repair Order Card & Pencil

THE KIT

Bronze-clad bike workbench
2.4m · €2,400 · custom

Tool wall set (24 wrenches + pedals + chainwhip) · €1,800

Espresso machine 3-group Bronze-clad · €6,400

Grinder Mahlkönig E80 · €3,800

Small roaster Probat 1kg · €5,200

Bronze-ceramic demitasse set ×20 · €380

Intake desk + pinned-form system · €280

Shop signage (hand-painted) · €520

Reclaimed-oak stool counter (6 seats) · €1,200

Bronze-ceramic demitasse set ×20 · €380

Bike-parts cabinet (oak + glass) · €680

Wall-mount vintage Colnago (signature) · €600

Milk fridge + ice machine · €1,200

Wheel truing stand · €420

POS + card reader · €290

MENU

(1) ESPRESSO · double shot · €2.80

(2) CORTADO · sage ceramic cup · €3.60

(3) FILTER · single origin of the week · €4.20

(4) FLAT TIRE FIX · pump + patch · €9

(5) FULL TUNE-UP · 30-min mechanic · €45

(6) BROKEN CHAIN · replace + rub · €32

(7) WHEEL TRUING · €22

(8) BRAKE BLEED · hydraulic · €38

(9) MONTHLY MEMBERSHIP · unlimited espresso + 2 tune-ups · €49

GOING HOME

coffee · roasted in brussels

bike tag · personal

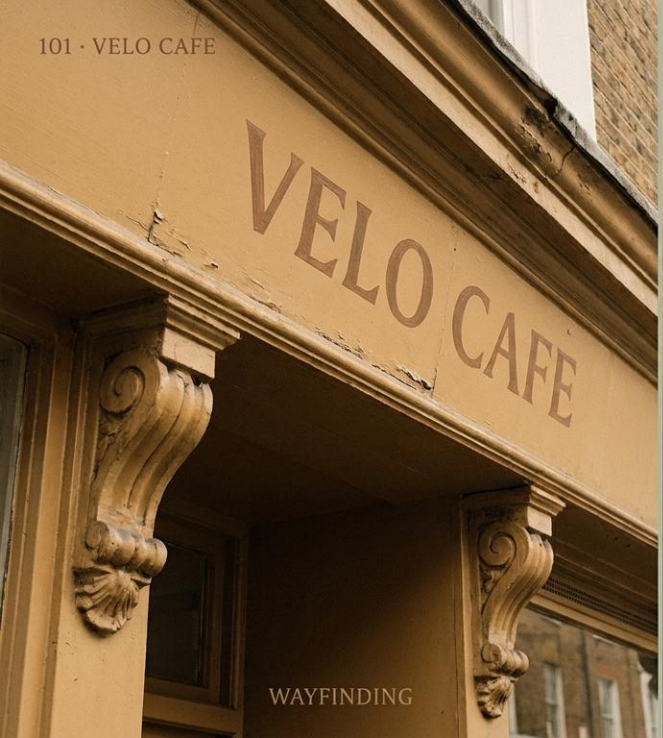
pickup card · local

keepsake · demitasse

chain wax · care

membership · 2024

membership · 2024



WAYFINDING

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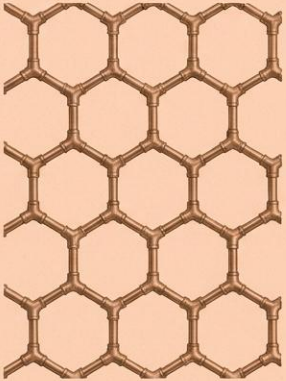
SAINT-GILLES · BRUSSELS · since 2026

IDENTITY

#E8B4A8	#8B6F4F	#B8927A	#C5A16F	#A8C2A8

Didone 'BRUXELLES' thin

hand-painted signage face

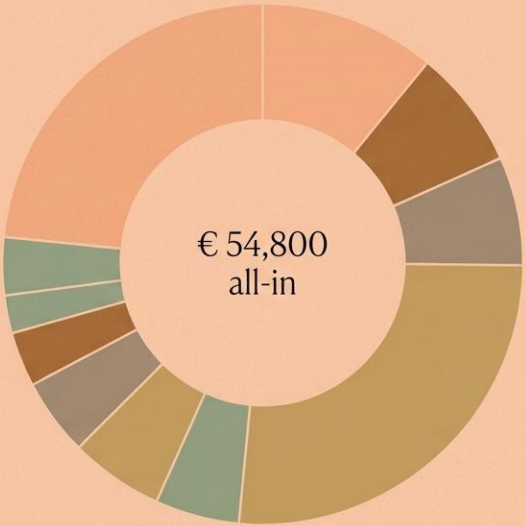


UNIT ECONOMICS

COVERS	140 *espressos + 6 repair-slots per day*
AVG TICKET	€11 *blended · coffee + service*
RENT	€1,500 */ month · 18 m² Saint-Gilles corner*
COGS	22 % *beans, milk, parts*
STAFF	2.5 FTE *barista + mechanic + weekend helper*
DAILY REVENUE	€780
MONTHLY GROSS	€18,720
MONTHLY NET	~ €7,900 *after rent, staff, COGS*
PAYBACK	~ 7 months *on ~€55k all-in CAPEX*

figures are European averages, illustrative — no guarantees.

CAPEX



Fit-out · concrete floor + paint + brick-clean · €6,200
Bronze-clad workbench + pipework · €3,400
Tool wall + mechanic kit · €3,800
Espresso machine + grinder + roaster · €15,400
Signage + hand-painted + brass plaques · €1,800
Reclaimed-oak seating + fixtures · €2,200
Bike-parts stock (cables/chains/tubes) · €3,600
Permits · commune Saint-Gilles · €1,400
Staff training + trial week · €1,200
Branding · kraft pouches · wax seals · €2,100
Opening reserve 3 months · €13,700

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EIGHT WEEKS

W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8
Lease · permits · commune paperwork							
Initial approvals & securing the space.							
Fit-out · brick clean · paint · concrete floor							
Core construction & surface preparation.							
	Bronze-clad workbench + pipework install						
	Custom fabrication & copper fixture installation.						
		Tool wall + mechanic kit in					
		Organizing bicycle repair tools & equipment.					
			Espresso · grinder · roaster install + calibration				
			Setting up and dialing in coffee machines.				
				Branding · signage · stamps · merch print			
				Developing and producing cafe identity.			
					Trial week · soft opening · Saint-Gilles neighbours		
					Inviting locals and friends for a test run.		

THE TEAM

LÉA · BARISTA

ex-Caffè Luigi Roma, walked into Brussels looking for rain · pulls every shot, no milk after 17:00 · 1.0 FTE.

TOM · MECHANIC

commune-Ixelles bike-co-op volunteer turned pro · knows every Brussels frame-builder · 1.0 FTE.

WEEKEND HELPER

barista-mechanic dual-trained · runs Saturdays when queues bend round the corner · 0.5 FTE.

ROLL OUT

SOPHIE
31, Bruxelles

Daily cortado, quarterly tune-up. Léa knows my order before I hang the bike.

DIMITRI
44, Ixelles

When my chain snaps at 18:30, Tom has already closed — but he opens the back door.

ANAÏS
26, Forest

I don't even own a bike. I just love the room's smell of coffee and chain-oil.

HOW THEY FIND US

INSTAGRAM

bronze pipes, saddle espresso, grinder dust — no Ikea-style café clichés.

STRAVA CLUB

VELO CAFE Brussels loop · weekly ride · coffee at the end.

BIKE MEDIA

GCN Benelux + Rouleur Brussels features, earned not paid.

COMMUNE PARTNERSHIPS

Saint-Gilles commune bike-to-work programme · first 20 employees of a firm get a membership.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

BRUSSELS WEATHER	*three months of rain reduces walk-ins · lean on membership revenue (pre-paid) · indoor-covered stand for arrivals.*
MECHANIC IS SOLO	*Tom gets flu, repair queue stalls · Léa trained to triage (flat/battery/quick tune), weekend helper can stand in for full service.*
COFFEE MARGINS	*Brussels coffee prices rising · roast our own 1kg Probat batches in W6+ · saves ~32% COGS long-term.*

WHY NOW

Brussels is a bike city.
Brussels is a coffee city.

Somehow they stayed on different streets.

We pulled them into one 18 m² corner,
added bronze pipework for the bench,
and closed the distance with a cortado,
added bronze pipework for the bench,
and closed the distance with a cortado.

WHAT YOU GET

Brandbook

Tools & Equipment

Financial Model (P&L)

Tracing-paper Floorplan

Menu

8-week Menu · Launch Plan · Checklist · QR · Membership

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CLAIM THIS CONCEPT

101 · VELO CAFE · BRUSSELS

CONCEPT · €49
"the 25-slide brandbook, delivered."

EXCLUSIVE · €149
"the brandbook, locked — only you receive it."

All figures are European averages, illustrative — no guarantees.

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